

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMBINED COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR
MIZORAM GROUP 'B' (GAZETTED) GENERAL SERVICES
UNDER EXCISE & NARCOTICS DEPARTMENT
&
FINANCE DEPARTMENT, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM
(SEPTEMBER-2026)

QUESTION BOOKLET
GENERAL ENGLISH

Question
Booklet Series

A

Time Allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 100

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Immediately after the commencement of the examination, you should check that this question booklet does not have any unprinted or torn or missing pages or items, etc. If so, get it replaced by a complete question booklet of the same series.
2. Write and encode clearly the question booklet series (A or B, as the case may be) in the appropriate place on the OMR Response Sheet.
3. **Particulars/Details to be filled up in the Answer Booklet and OMR Response Sheet should be filled up completely and correctly, candidates failing to do so will NOT be evaluated.**
4. This Question Booklet contains *Part - 'A' & 'B'*. *Part - 'A' should be answered only on the Answer Booklet provided and Part - 'B' should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet .*
5. For Part- 'B' section you have to mark all your responses only on the separate OMR Response Sheet provided. See directions in the OMR Response Sheet.
6. Separate sheets for rough work will be provided in the Examination Hall.
7. After the examination has concluded, you must hand over the OMR Response Sheet/Answer Booklet and Rough Sheet to the Invigilator only. You are permitted to take away with you only the Question Booklet.
8. There will be penalty (negative marking). For each incorrect answer in the MCQ, one-third (1/3rd) of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted.

PART - A (Conventional Type) (34 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.*

Marks for each question is indicated against it.

1. Write the precis of the following passage, giving it a suitable title: (14)

The FIFA World Cup is the globe's most prestigious football tournament, held every four years by the Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA). Uniting billions of fans and national teams, this monumental event transcends sports, serving as a powerful engine for global unity, cultural exchange, and international economic growth.

Often referred to as the "beautiful Game," football has a universal appeal that requires nothing more than a ball and an open space. The World Cup serves as the pinnacle of this sport, elevating the passion of local communities onto the international stage. Every four years, it captures the attention of a massive global audience, making it the most-watched sporting event on the planet. For participating nations, the tournament is a profound source of national pride, where everyday life pauses as communities gather to cheer for their country's color.

The tournament was first established in 1930 under the vision of then-FIFA President Jules Rimet. Since its inaugural competition in Uruguay, the event has grown exponentially in scale and competitive intensity. Over the decades, legendary teams and iconic players—such as Pelé, Diego Maradona, and Lionel Messi—have etched their names into sports history, creating enduring legacies. The event has also adapted to modern demands, integrating advanced technology like Video Assistant Referee (VAR) systems to ensure fairness and accuracy in high-stakes matches.

Beyond the thrill of the matches, the World Cup carries profound socio-economic and cultural significance. It acts as a massive cultural melting pot, allowing diverse sets of fans from various backgrounds to share traditions, celebrate together, and foster mutual understanding. For the host nation, the World Cup is a massive undertaking that brings in billions of dollars through tourism, sponsorships, and media rights, while driving infrastructure development like modern stadiums and transport networks.

The FIFA World Cup is more than just a month-long sporting competition; it is a global phenomenon that brings humanity together in a shared passion. Despite political and logistical challenges, its ability to unite people across borders, languages, and cultures remains unparalleled. The tournament leaves a lasting legacy by inspiring generations of young players, cementing national identities, and celebrating the sheer joy of the beautiful game.

2. You are Rinhlua, living at Raven Colony, Chandmari, Aizawl. You purchased a washing machine last week from M.S. Stores, at Aizawl Bazaar, but it was not working properly when brought home. Write a complaint letter to the dealer to raise the issue regarding the same, with necessary details. (10)

3. Read the given passages carefully and answer the questions that follow. The marks for each question are indicated at the end of the question:

Marketing is all about creativity and expression, so it must be an art, right? Not necessarily. While marketers once relied purely on instinct, they now rely on data-driven insights. On top of that, cutting-edge technologies and analytics have shifted the focus of marketing further toward the science side of the spectrum. Armed with so much data, marketers can now track the impact of money spent on their bottom line.

In today's world, the best approach to marketing combines both disciplines. And there's a distinct balance to the craft—a strategic mix of interpersonal empathy and tactical analysis. Neither side of the mix can be isolated or ignored, or the results will not be encouraging. Psychologists believe the brain is separated into two distinct functions: the left-brain and the right-brain. The right side of the brain is responsible for creative thinking and artistic intuition.

As an art, marketing is all about understanding the nuances of human behaviour and determining how to make an emotional connection with the customer. More importantly, some level of art is needed to create brand standards for your company, including the logo, messaging, and overall visual identity for the brand.

Right-brained marketers focus on the creative—the copy, graphics and emotions tied to the message. The science side of marketing tells us to let the data guide what strategies will be most effective. Marketers are now reporting the need for digital-first expertise, including digital proficiency, data analysis, and data science. With science, marketers adopt an outcome-centric mindset that helps them curate smarter campaigns. Over the past few years, there has been an evolving prioritisation of data-savvy talent. In 2020 and beyond, brands will need to focus on recruiting talent that can understand the complexities of AI and machine technologies.

But when we reflect on earlier times, marketing was defined as the predominance of traditional advertising, like television, newspaper, and direct mail. Today, it ropes in digital channels, social media, mobile devices, and integrated, complex campaigns. And just as consumers today are more tech-savvy, employees should be able to match—and exceed—their expertise. It is important that brands continue to prioritise creative, engaging campaign messages while also focusing on key insights and performance metrics for optimal results.

- (i) How does the author describe the evolution of marketing? (2)
- (ii) Provide one textual evidence with reference to paragraph 3 to support that marketing is an art. (1)
- (iii) Based on the passage, assess the way data and digital platforms have transformed the field of marketing and employment. (2)
- (iv) What does the writer refer to when he says ‘cutting-edge technologies’? (1)
- (v) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph 2:
Included : incorporated : _____ : secluded. (1)
 - (a) approach (b) empathy
 - (c) isolated (d) Intuition
- (vi) According to the writer, modern marketing is built on both _____ and _____. (1)
- (vii) With reference to para 5, what skills do you think the employees should possess to match the demand of the consumers? (1)
- (viii) What fascinating fact about the human brain is revealed by the writer in the above passage? (1)

PART- B (Multiple Choice Questions) (66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1. Attempt all questions.

*The questions in this Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1- 10): Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:

1. What do you know about this situation?
(a) Adverb (b) Verb
(c) Preposition (d) Pronoun
2. Past tense refers to the time gone by.
(a) Preposition (b) Adverb
(c) Adjective (d) Noun
3. Neither of the two boys is qualified for this post.
(a) Pronoun (b) Conjunction
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
4. The surface of the lake was perfectly still.
(a) Adjective (b) Noun
(c) Adverb (d) Verb
5. One man came in the name of love.
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Pronoun (d) Preposition
6. As I am unwell, I am unable to come.
(a) Pronoun (b) Preposition
(c) Adverb (d) Conjunction
7. You must come inside right now.
(a) Noun (b) Preposition
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
8. What! you dare to disobey your king?
(a) Pronoun (b) Conjunction
(c) Interjection (d) Adjective
9. I shall never act like that.
(a) Noun (b) Preposition
(c) Adjective (d) Adverb
10. We must back him in his proposal.
(a) Verb (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Preposition

Direction (Question Nos. 11- 14): Choose the antonym of the following:

11. Convivial

- (a) Antisocial
- (c) Vivacious

- (b) Unclear
- (d) Parallel

12. Frugal

- (a) Miserly
- (c) Spendthrift

- (b) Generous
- (d) Cruel

13. Ephemeral

- (a) Tangible
- (c) Permanent

- (b) Temporary
- (d) Amorphous

14. Apathy

- (a) Indifference
- (c) Constant

- (b) Static
- (d) Sympathy

Direction (Question Nos. 15- 18): Choose the synonym of the following:

15. Contrary

- (a) Agreeable
- (c) Friendly

- (b) Opposite
- (d) Enmity

16. Inevitable

- (a) Undefeatable
- (c) Avoidable

- (b) Defeatable
- (d) Unavoidable

17. Contentious

- (a) Peaceful
- (c) Doubtful

- (b) Serious
- (d) Argumentative

18. Inquisitive

- (a) Curious
- (c) Clever

- (b) Unintelligent
- (d) Careful

Direction (Question Nos. 19 - 22): Choose the most appropriate word to fill in the blanks:

19. The driver's _____ disrespect towards the policeman earned him a fine.

- (a) fragrant
- (c) flagellant

- (b) flagrant
- (d) fragment

20. His income was not sufficient to support his _____ lifestyle.

- (a) hellenistic
- (c) hieroglyphic

- (b) hysterical
- (d) hedonistic

21. Gold becomes _____ when heated, and can be easily shaped.

- (a) malevolent
- (c) malleable

- (b) malignant
- (d) mellowable

22. The runner wiped the _____ from her forehead as she ran under the hot sun.
- (a) perspication (b) expiration
(c) perspiration (d) inspiration

Direction (Question Nos. 23- 26): Choose the correct meaning of the following idioms and phrases:

23. To seize the day
- (a) To try to achieve something that is doomed to failure
(b) To begin work the moment you wake up
(c) To finish off one's work the moment the day is done
(d) To make the most of the present moment without worrying about the future
24. A bone of contention
- (a) A shared experience that brings great joy
(b) A cause of dispute
(c) A seemingly small event that ends up having a lot of impact
(d) An integral part
25. A close-fisted man
- (a) A man who is prone to violence (b) A miserly person
(c) Someone who can keep a secret (d) A cowardly person
26. To read between the lines
- (a) To discover a hidden meaning (b) To be constantly suspicious over nothing
(c) To follow rules and instructions exactly (d) To pick a quarrel

Direction (Question Nos. 27 - 36): Choose the correct form of the verb that agrees with the subject of the sentences to make complete sense:

27. The box of old toys _____ in the attic.
- (a) has (b) have
(c) belong (d) belongs
28. Bread and butter _____ my favourite breakfast.
- (a) has always been (b) have always been
(c) were (d) weren't
29. The cat and the dog _____ on the rug.
- (a) sleeps (b) sleep
(c) is (d) was
30. You and he _____ of the same feather.
- (a) is birds (b) are birds
(c) are bird (d) was bird
31. A number of girls _____ copying.
- (a) was caught (b) has caught
(c) were caught (d) is caught

32. Many interesting suggestions _____ been made.
(a) have (b) has
(c) was (d) were
33. Politics with him _____ the business of his life.
(a) was (b) were
(c) have been (d) are
34. A variety of pleasing objects _____ the eye.
(a) is mesmerising (b) mesmerise
(c) are mesmerising (d) mesmerises
35. Mani, as well as Rahul and Mohan, _____ hot chicken curry.
(a) like (b) is like
(c) likes (d) are liked
36. Neither you nor your sister should _____ to them.
(a) talk (b) talks
(c) talked (d) talking

Direction (Question Nos. 37 - 46): Choose the prepositions from the choices provided to form correct sentences:

37. Kima remained cheerful _____ his illness.
(a) with (b) from
(c) throughout (d) under
38. After a long discussion, I prevailed _____ him to accept the proposal.
(a) upon (b) against
(c) to (d) with
39. The children were freed _____ the danger.
(a) of (b) from
(c) with (d) about
40. Do you know the reason _____ his absence?
(a) of (b) for
(c) by (d) none of the above
41. Mapuii has not read anything _____ Monday.
(a) for (b) since
(c) of (d) over
42. This idea is in conformity _____ the rules laid down by the Corporation.
(a) for (b) against
(c) about (d) with
43. The Indian Airlines plane flew _____ the city.
(a) across (b) over
(c) beside (d) behind

44. He applied _____ the bank _____ a loan.
(a) at/for (b) on/for
(c) with/for (d) to/on
45. I am translating this book _____ English _____ Turkish.
(a) on/over (b) from/over
(c) to/into (d) from/into
46. He is thinking _____ retiring _____ his post several years before the normal age.
(a) about/of (b) of/from
(c) of/for (d) about/by

Direction (Question Nos. 47 - 52): Identify the correct form of tenses for the sentences below. Choose from the options provided:

47. She has taken her medicines.
(a) Simple present (b) Present perfect
(c) Simple past (d) Past perfect
48. I have been working on the project for the past two years.
(a) Present perfect (b) Past perfect
(c) Present perfect continuous (d) Past perfect continuous
49. They will reap the fruit of their labour soon.
(a) Present perfect (b) Future continuous
(c) Simple future (d) Simple present
50. Meena had all her classes in the morning today.
(a) Simple past (b) Past perfect
(c) Present perfect (d) Present perfect continuous
51. The hostel girls are travelling to Ooty in November.
(a) Simple past continuous (b) Past perfect continuous
(c) Present perfect continuous (d) Present continuous
52. They will have finished ploughing the paddy field when I reach there.
(a) Present perfect continuous (b) Past perfect continuous
(c) Future perfect continuous (d) Future continuous

Direction (Question Nos. 53 - 59): Identify the type of sentences and choose the right answer from the options provided:

53. Please clean your cupboard today.
(a) Declarative (b) Imperative
(c) Exclamatory (d) Interrogative
54. I love reading lengthy storybooks.
(a) Assertive (b) Imperative
(c) Exclamatory (d) Interrogative

55. Such a unique and beautiful place!
(a) Declarative (b) Imperative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory
56. Can there be more than two answers to a question?
(a) Declarative (b) Imperative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory
57. Never let jealousy overpower you.
(a) Declarative (b) Imperative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory
58. Is the Pacific Ocean the largest in the world?
(a) Assertive (b) Imperative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory
59. Well, there can be only one correct answer to the question.
(a) Assertive (b) Imperative
(c) Interrogative (d) Exclamatory

Direction (Question Nos. 60 - 66): Identify the type of phrases or clauses marked in *Italics* in the sentences and choose the correct answer from the options given:

60. He thinks, *because he is rich*, he can buy justice.
(a) Adjective clause (b) Adverb clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Adjective phrase
61. He is the boy *who broke the window*.
(a) Adjective clause (b) Adverb clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Adjective phrase
62. I cannot tell *what has become of him*.
(a) Adjective clause (b) Adverb clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Noun clause
63. *Early to bed* is a good maxim.
(a) Noun phrase (b) Noun clause
(c) Adjective phrase (d) Adjective clause
64. Rama ran *with great speed*.
(a) Noun phrase (b) Noun clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Adverb clause
65. The magistrate was a man *with a kindly nature*.
(a) Adverb clause (b) Adverb phrase
(c) Adjective phrase (d) Adjective clause
66. *That you have come* pleases me.
(a) Noun phrase (b) Noun clause
(c) Adverb phrase (d) Adverb clause